

Q Where does open source technology fit in the storage world?

OpenStack is an important project for HP, and will remain so in the future as well. A lot of the other storage members are now joining the OpenStack platform. To deploy SDS, you would like as open an architecture as possible. Because once you introduce SDS, you are actually bringing in one level of complexity into the data centre. So, if SDS is not made as flexible and open as possible, you will be able to explore its architecture in a limited manner. Even if you have hardware based efficient platforms, you will still be governed by SDS, as it will lie as the top layer. Possibly, that is why OpenStack needs to be inbuilt in your data centre. So, open source technology is a must in the world of storage.

Q In percentage terms, how many CIOs do you see being receptive to open source technology?

Globally, 40 to 50 per cent of CIOs are willing to adopt open source, but in India, this comes down to 10 to 20 per cent.

Q What is inhibiting them?

Most of them are still stuck in old ways of thinking. And they do not want to change so radically. SDS, Flash architecture, *et al*, are radical changes for them. Indians do not adapt to leading edge technologies like these. A lot of CIOs are apprehensive about such technologies. You may find it hard to believe, but a lot of CIOs are still apprehensive about the

cloud. They tend to think that with the cloud, the power to control may slip out of their hands. I believe that CIOs should be progressive in embracing change.

Q So, how is the storage space evolving in India?

I see Flash adoption being really high. I think customers are thinking far more proactively and their knowledge of storage is way higher, than what it used to be three years back. I can quote a customer in Ahmedabad, who said that storage is the heart of his data centre. Customers now feel that storage has become much more important to them than possibly changing their server landscape.

Q So, how are IT heads dealing with the spurt of data that we are seeing with trends like Big Data, mobility, social media and the cloud?

I think they have learned how to deal with it. As an IT head, I may not know if my server will have one million hits today and 10 million hits tomorrow. All I know is that I need to have an infrastructure which can give seamless responses to the customers, even when traffic is 10 times more than usual. It is becoming increasingly important for IT heads to be prepared for unprecedented data growth and unprecedented access to a particular network. If they are not ready to deal with unprecedented traffic, the system will just hang, leading to a loss of customers. **END** 

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